

HMF Design Clinic Activity Guide

Everything a facilitator needs to run the Cedarline Hybrid Mesh Firewall clinic.

The mission

Today your team is the Cisco Solution Engineering team walking into Cedarline. You will sit with four real conversations, hear what is keeping them up at night, and answer as Solution Engineers do, with the right solution, why it fits, and the outcome it delivers, all brought together into one Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

The scenario

Cedarline Health Group is a regional healthcare payer-provider with roughly 8,000 employees across four hospitals and thirty-one clinics, plus a claims-processing business that handles the money. Growth by acquisition (including a second data centre absorbed as-is) and a mid-flight, disorderly move to public cloud have left a fragmented security posture. After a security incident in March, the board asked what would have stopped it, and leadership still cannot answer. Budget and executive attention are approved but explicitly temporary, and the security team is small.

Learning objectives

- 1 Map Cedarline's stated concerns to the right Cisco Secure solutions.
- 2 Explain, in the customer's language, how each solution addresses the concern.
- 3 Connect the four case studies into one coherent Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.
- 4 Present the business outcome, not just the feature.

The four case studies

- 1 **Case Study 1**
Cedarline is standing up AI across regulated workflows and public cloud faster than security can see it. Help them prove compliance, vet what they adopt, and get visibility and guardrails over AI traffic.
- 2 **Case Study 2**
Workloads sprawl across AWS, Azure and on-prem, each with its own policy model. Contain lateral movement, prove consistent controls to auditors, and give Cedarline one place to define and enforce policy.
- 3 **Case Study 3**
A mixed-vendor perimeter, an inherited rulebase and mostly encrypted traffic leave blind spots and a slow response. Restore visibility, speed the response, and modernise detection with the team they have.
- 4 **Case Study 4**
A flat data centre and fragmented Kubernetes networking invite east-west movement. Build segmentation Cedarline can adopt safely, with runtime visibility and application-dependency awareness so nothing breaks.

How to run it

- Each table forms a **team of 8**. Give every team a **Workbook**.
- Work all four case studies, four pain points each. For every one, give the **product or platform** and the **SE response** that covers how it addresses the concern and the outcome.
- Finish by combining everything into one **Hybrid Mesh Firewall topology**. Teams submit the diagram for **SME review**; it is reviewed, not scored.
- Suggested total: about **75 minutes**, roughly 10 minutes per case study plus 15 minutes for the topology and readout.

Facilitating a team of 8

- Split the eight into **four pairs**, one pair per case study, working in parallel, then reconvene so the whole team agrees each answer.
- Assign light roles: a **timekeeper**, a **scribe** for the workbook, and a **presenter** for the readout.
- Bring the four case studies together as a team for the **topology**, so everyone contributes to the single HMF design.
- Keep the room moving with time checks at the end of each case study.

How we score

Each case study is scored across its **four pain points**, giving a **case study score** and an **overall score** for the clinic. Alongside the score, the three dimensions below are provided as **qualitative feedback**. The topology diagram is **submitted for SME review**, not scored.

Problem Identifier

Correctly identified the customer's pain point and the requirements behind it.

Solution Designer

Recommended the right Cisco solution, architecture, and approach.

Value Communicator

Clearly explained how the solution works and the customer outcomes it enables.

Teams use the **HMF product and feature reference** in the Workbook to identify products themselves; it is a uniform list with no pain-point give-aways. Facilitators evaluate each Workbook against the **Grading Guide**, which breaks down the expected answer for every pain point, and record scores and feedback there.